

FROM CHEAP TALK TO CALIBRATED TRUST

A transparent commitment bond changes the cost of breaking an AI promise.

PROBLEM

Cheap talk: a promise does not change the payoff from breaking it.

PARTICIPANT

1. Forecast compliance
2. Invest s from 10 points

AI RECEIVER + BOND

Receives $3s$; promises $3s/2$.
A violation transfers $2s$ to the participant.

OUTCOMES

Compliance · investment
Payoffs · calibration

PRIMARY: one-shot causal comparison

Fixed 50/50 hidden types; vary only cheap talk versus bond.

EXTENSION: eight-round learning visualization

Five cheap-talk rounds → three bond rounds; updating, not a causal estimate.